

AN ESSAY



RATTY2TAILS

Building on Rock

What money really is, how Bitcoin works, why the dollar is being rebuilt beneath our feet — and what is ultimately at stake.

Written by **Ratty2Tails**, for the intelligent reader with no background in finance — everything is explained from first principles.

Drawing on the conversation between **Matt Dines** and **Danny Knowles** on the **What Bitcoin Did** podcast, "*The Dollar Changed. Bitcoin Is the Endgame.*"

I. What Money Actually Is

Before we can understand Bitcoin, or why serious people believe the dollar itself is being quietly rebuilt, we have to understand the thing both are competing to be: *money*. We use it every day without ever asking what it is, and that unexamined familiarity is precisely what allows it to be changed underneath us without our noticing.

Money is a tool, and like all tools it was invented to solve a problem. The problem is barter. Imagine a baker who wants shoes and a cobbler who wants bread; they can trade directly, and everyone is happy. But now imagine the baker wants shoes while the cobbler wants not bread but a chicken. The trade collapses. For barter to work, two people must each happen to want exactly what the other has, at exactly the same moment — what economists call the "double coincidence of wants." In any economy larger than a village, those coincidences almost never line up. Money is the human solution to this deadlock: a single good that *everyone* is willing to accept, not because they want it for itself, but because they know they can pass it on to anyone else. It is the universal middle-step that lets the baker sell bread to the world and buy shoes from the world, without ever needing to find one specific person who wants bread and makes shoes.

Out of that single purpose, money performs three distinct jobs. Economists describe them as the three functions of money, and a good money does all three at once.

1. A medium of exchange

This is the job we just described: money is the thing you can hand over for goods and services and be confident it will be accepted. It dissolves the double-coincidence problem and lets specialisation flourish — a farmer can farm, a doctor can doctor, a teacher can teach, and each can convert their narrow skill into everything else they need by passing money back and forth. Nearly all the prosperity of the modern world rests on this one quiet function.

2. A unit of account

Money is also a measuring stick. Just as we measure distance in metres and weight in kilograms, we measure value in dollars or pounds. This sounds trivial, but it is what makes economic life legible. Because every price is quoted in the same unit, you can compare a loaf of bread to an hour of labour to a house, keep accounts, plan a budget, calculate a profit, and decide whether a business is worth

building. Without a common unit of account, prices would be a fog of incomparable ratios. With one, the whole economy becomes a single shared spreadsheet that everyone can read.

3. A store of value

Finally, money lets you move purchasing power through time. You work today, you are paid, and you trust that the money you hold will still buy roughly the same amount next month, next year, or in the retirement that is decades away. This is the function that lets people save, invest, and plan for the future rather than spending frantically the moment they earn. It is also, by far, the hardest of the three to get right — and, as we will see, the one most quietly under attack.

Through history, societies tested many things as money — cattle, salt, shells, beads, glass, stones, and above all the precious metals. The reason gold ultimately won, for thousands of years, is that it scored well on the properties a good money needs. It is *durable* (it does not rot or rust). It is *portable* enough to carry meaningful value. It is *divisible* (you can split it into coins of any size). It is *fungible* (one ounce is interchangeable with any other). It is *verifiable* (you can test its purity). And, decisively, it is *scarce* — you cannot conjure it from nothing; you must dig it painfully out of the earth. That scarcity is what let gold hold its value across centuries, making it the finest store of value humanity had ever found.

But gold has a fatal practical weakness in a global economy: it is heavy, hard to move across the world, and hard to verify at a distance. So societies began storing their gold in vaults and circulating paper claims on it instead — and once the money is paper and the gold is locked away by a trusted few, the door is open to a very old temptation: printing more paper claims than there is gold to back them. This is **debasement**, and it is as old as money itself. Roman emperors shaved the silver from their coins; kings clipped the edges; modern central banks simply create new currency. Each time, the people holding the old money are silently robbed: their store of value leaks away as the supply swells. Keep that image in mind — the quiet falsification of the measuring stick — because it is the thread that runs through everything that follows.

II. What Bitcoin Is — A New Kind of Money

In 2008, in the depths of the global financial crisis, an anonymous person or group using the name **Satoshi Nakamoto** published a nine-page document titled *Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System*. A few months later, in January 2009, the network went live. Embedded in its very first block was a line of text — the headline of that day's *Times* of London: a note that the Chancellor was on the

brink of a second bailout for the banks. It was a timestamp, but also a manifesto. Bitcoin was born as a direct response to a monetary system that prints money to rescue the powerful at everyone else's expense.

So what, precisely, is it? Bitcoin is three things at once. It is a *network* of computers around the world. It is a *protocol* — a fixed set of rules those computers all agree to follow. And it is the *unit* of money native to that network, the bitcoin itself. To grasp why it matters, you have to understand a handful of principles that make it unlike any money that came before.

It is ***decentralised***. There is no Bitcoin company. There is no chief executive, no board of directors, no headquarters, no office you could raid, no founder you could arrest, no customer-service line you could call to demand a change. This is not a marketing slogan; it is the deepest fact about the system. A bank can freeze your account; a payment company can ban you; a government can lean on either to do its bidding. But there is no one sitting at the centre of Bitcoin to lean on, because there is no centre. The network is run by thousands of independent computers, operated by people who do not know each other and answer to no common authority, scattered across every continent. Rules without rulers.

It is ***open source***. The entire codebase is public. Anyone on earth can read it, audit it, run it, copy it, or propose improvements. There are no hidden levers, no secret backdoors, no privileged accounts. The monetary policy — how many coins exist and how new ones are created — is written in code that everyone can inspect and that no one can quietly alter. Compare that to the central bank's interest-rate decisions, made by a small committee behind closed doors.

It is ***independent of governments and banks***. You do not need anyone's permission to use it. You do not need an account, an ID, or an institution's blessing. The network does not care who you are or where you live. It cannot be straightforwardly shut down, because to stop it you would have to stop every node on the planet simultaneously. Its supply schedule is fixed by mathematics, not by political expediency.

And it is ***cryptographically secured***. Ownership of bitcoin is established not by a name on an account but by a secret number called a *private key*. From that private key, the software derives a *public key* and an address — think of the address as a transparent mailbox anyone can send to, and the private key as the only key that can open it. When you want to spend, you use your private key to produce a digital *signature*: a piece of mathematics that proves you authorised the transaction, which anyone can verify against your public key — without ever learning your secret. It is the difference between proving you know a password and revealing the password itself. This is why Bitcoiners say "not your

keys, not your coins." If you hold your own private keys, no bank, government, or third party stands between you and your money. You are, for the first time in the digital age, your own vault.

III. How the Blockchain Is Secured — Proof of Work and Consensus

There is an obvious problem with the idea of digital money, and for decades it defeated everyone who tried to build it. Anything digital can be copied perfectly and infinitely — a photo, a song, a file. If a coin is just a digital file, what stops me from spending the same coin twice, copying it and sending it to two different people? In the old world, the solution was a central authority — a bank — keeping a master ledger and checking every transaction. But a central authority is exactly what Bitcoin was designed to do without. Satoshi's breakthrough was to solve this "double-spend problem" with no one in charge. The solution is the **blockchain**, secured by **proof of work**.

Picture a single public ledger — a record of every transaction that has ever happened — that everyone in the network holds a copy of. Transactions are gathered into batches called **blocks**, and a new block is added roughly every ten minutes. Each block is stamped with a digital fingerprint of the block before it, so the blocks form an unbroken *chain* stretching back to the very first one. This is what makes the ledger tamper-evident: if anyone tried to alter a transaction buried in an old block, that block's fingerprint would change, which would break its link to the next block, and the next, and the next — the forgery would be visible to the entire network instantly.

These fingerprints are produced by a tool called a **cryptographic hash** (Bitcoin uses one named SHA-256). A hash function takes any input — a word, a book, an entire block of transactions — and produces a fixed-length string of characters that acts as a unique fingerprint. Change a single comma in the input and the entire fingerprint changes completely and unpredictably. It is a one-way street: from the input you can instantly compute the fingerprint, but from the fingerprint you can never work backwards to the input. Hashing is the mathematical glue that binds the chain together.

Now for the genius of it. Who gets to add the next block, and how do we stop bad actors from flooding the network with fraudulent ones? This is where the work of "proof of work" comes in. Special participants called **miners** compete to add each block, and to win the right they must solve a deliberately hard puzzle: they must find a number that, when hashed together with the block, produces a fingerprint below a certain target — a fingerprint starting with a long run of zeros. There is no clever shortcut. The only way to find it is to guess, billions upon billions of times per second, burning real

electricity through purpose-built machines. Finding the answer is staggeringly difficult; but once found, anyone can verify it is correct in a single instant. The miner who finds it first broadcasts the new block to the world and is rewarded with newly created bitcoin.

This converts electricity and physics into security. To rewrite history — to undo a past transaction — an attacker would have to redo the proof-of-work puzzle for that block *and* every block built on top of it, all while racing to outpace the combined honest effort of the entire global network adding new blocks ahead of them. The cost would be astronomical and the prize would not be worth it. Honesty is simply cheaper than fraud. The valid chain, by definition, is the one with the most accumulated work behind it; this is what is meant by ***Nakamoto consensus***. The longest, heaviest chain is the truth.

There is one more pillar, and it is the one most often missed. Miners propose blocks, but they do not get to decide the rules. Every ***full node*** — and there are tens of thousands, run by ordinary users, businesses, and enthusiasts — keeps its own complete copy of the ledger and independently checks every single rule: that every signature is valid, that no coin is spent twice, that not one satoshi more than the schedule allows has been created. If a miner produces a block that breaks the rules, every node rejects it and the miner's electricity is wasted for nothing. This is the subtle, profound source of Bitcoin's power: the rules are enforced not by the miners with all the hardware, but by the distributed multitude of validators. The users hold the constitution. This is how thousands of strangers who have no reason to trust one another nonetheless reach perfect agreement about who owns what — a puzzle computer scientists call the "Byzantine Generals Problem," and one that Bitcoin was the first system in history to solve.

IV. Scarcity by Design — 21 Million, Halvings, and the Difficulty Adjustment

We said the hardest job of money is to store value, and that the great failure of every money before it has been debasement — the issuer printing more. Bitcoin's most radical feature is that this is simply impossible. The total supply is capped, forever, at just under ***21 million coins***, and that limit is not a promise made by a person who could break it. It is a property enforced by every node on the network, every ten minutes, of its own accord.

Here is how the cap is reached. New bitcoin come into existence in exactly one way: as the reward paid to the miner who adds each block. That reward is not constant. Every 210,000 blocks — which works out to roughly every four years — it is cut in half, in an event Bitcoiners call ***the halving***. The

reward began at 50 bitcoin per block in 2009, fell to 25, then 12.5, then 6.25, and after the 2024 halving sits at 3.125. This steady halving forms a decreasing series that sums to a hard ceiling of nearly 21 million, with the final fractions to be mined around the year 2140. More than ninety per cent of all the bitcoin that will ever exist have already been issued. Once the last is mined, miners will be paid by transaction fees alone, and not a single new coin will ever be created again. For the first time in history, humanity has a money of *absolutely fixed* supply — what some call absolute scarcity. No emperor, no chancellor, no committee can dilute it.

But a fixed schedule raises a practical question. We said a new block arrives roughly every ten minutes. Yet the amount of mining power pointed at the network is wildly variable — miners switch machines on and off, electricity prices shift, vast new mining farms come online. If more and more computing power piled in, blocks would be found faster and faster, the coins would be issued too quickly, and the whole schedule would collapse. Bitcoin's answer is one of its quietest masterpieces: the **difficulty adjustment**. Every 2,016 blocks — about once every two weeks — the network looks at how long those blocks actually took, and automatically recalibrates the difficulty of the puzzle. If blocks were coming too fast, the puzzle gets harder; too slow, and it gets easier. It is a self-correcting thermostat with no one operating it. However much or however little mining power exists, the network steers itself back toward that ten-minute heartbeat. This is what makes the fixed supply robust rather than fragile: the issuance stays on schedule no matter what the world throws at it.

And why ten minutes? It is a deliberate compromise. Blocks must be spaced far enough apart that, when one is found, news of it can ripple out to every node across the planet before the next one appears — otherwise miners would constantly stumble over each other, wasting work on competing versions of history. Ten minutes is long enough to keep the global network in sync and short enough to settle transactions in a reasonable time. It is, in effect, the steady pulse of the system — the beat to which the whole network keeps time.

v. Scaling Trust — The Lightning Network

This security comes at a price. Because every node must store and verify every transaction for all time, the base layer of Bitcoin cannot process the torrent of payments a Visa or a Mastercard handles — millions per second. It deliberately trades raw speed for unbreakable decentralisation and security. If you tried to put every coffee and every bus fare on the base chain directly, only the wealthiest could afford to run a node, and the whole thing would re-centralise into the very kind of system it was built

to escape. So the everyday payments are moved up a level, onto a second layer built on top — the most important of which is the *Lightning Network*.

Lightning works through what are called *payment channels*. Two parties lock some bitcoin into a shared account on the base chain — technically an address that requires both of their signatures to spend from. Once that channel is open, the two can send payments back and forth between themselves instantly and almost for free, simply by re-signing an updated tally of who owns what within the channel. None of these back-and-forth payments touch the slow, public base chain; only the opening and the eventual closing of the channel do. Thousands of transactions can happen off-chain, secured by signatures the parties hold, and the base layer only ever sees the final settled balance.

The brilliance is that you do not need a direct channel with every person you might want to pay. Channels link together into a web, and a payment can hop across several of them to reach anyone in the network — from you, to a friend you share a channel with, to a merchant they share a channel with, and so on. This routing is made safe by a clever mechanism (a hashed timelock contract) that makes each multi-hop payment all-or-nothing: either the whole path succeeds and everyone is paid, or the entire thing unwinds and no one along the route can steal a thing. The result is instant, final, near-free payments at essentially unlimited scale, all ultimately anchored to Bitcoin's rock-solid base layer.

The right way to picture it is as a layered system, which is exactly how robust money has always worked. The base chain is like the great settlement rails between banks — slow, expensive, but absolutely final and supremely secure, used for the largest and most important transfers. Lightning is like cash in your pocket or the tap of a card — fast, cheap, and perfect for the small payments of daily life. Different layers for different jobs, each settling down onto the secure foundation beneath it. Hold that image of layers settling onto a foundation, because it is about to become the whole point.

VI. The Dollar's Quiet Transformation

From here on, the essay turns to the argument made by Matt Dines — a fixed-income portfolio manager who works inside these markets — in the cited podcast. What follows is his interpretive framework about contested, fast-moving events. It is presented to show how a sophisticated insider reads the present moment, not as settled fact or prediction. Treat it as a lens.

Dines's central claim is unsettling precisely because it is invisible: the dollar is being structurally rebuilt, and most people are navigating with a map that is already out of date. Just as we saw that "money" can be quietly changed underneath us, he argues that "the dollar" has in fact meant several

different things over its history — anchored to gold after the Second World War, cut loose from gold by Nixon in 1971, and reshaped again and again since. We are, he says, living through another of these rare structural turns, and it is hard to see clearly from the inside.

The system we are leaving he calls the *offshore dollar* — the vast ocean of dollars created and used *outside* the United States, all over the world, to grease the wheels of global trade. For decades its centre of gravity was London, and the price of borrowing those dollars was set by a benchmark called LIBOR — a number that, remarkably, a handful of large banks simply reported each day, with no real money at stake, like restaurants self-reporting their own prices on the honour system. Crucially, this was a *liability-based* dollar: in this system every dollar is somebody's debt, an IOU created by a bank when it makes a loan. It is the ledger of promises we described earlier, stretched across the entire planet.

The shift, in his telling, is a quiet relocation of power. The old London benchmark, LIBOR, has been replaced by a new American one called SOFR, run by the New York Federal Reserve — and unlike the honour-system number, SOFR is built on real overnight loans in which the borrower must post collateral, almost always U.S. government bonds. The price of the world's dollars moved from London to New York, and gained "skin in the game" in the process. He marks 2022 as the decisive year, when a brutal campaign of interest-rate rises, the shock of the war in Ukraine, and the end of a forty-year bull market in bonds combined into a single inflection point — the moment, as he puts it, that the old cross-Atlantic partnership stopped cooperating and the other side's hand hit the table.

Then, in 2025, came the legislation he regards as the hinge of the whole story: a law (the GENIUS Act) regulating *stablecoins* — digital tokens designed to always be worth one dollar — and requiring each token to be backed one-for-one by short-term U.S. government IOUs, the Treasury bills we have been describing. This, he argues, is a profound change in the nature of the dollar itself. The old offshore dollar was a *liability* — pure debt. The new stablecoin dollar is *asset-backed* — there is a real, tangible government bond sitting behind every token. The dollar is being re-anchored, its operating centre dragged away from London and toward Washington and New York. In his map, there are now effectively three competing dollars — the new stablecoin dollar held up by Treasury bills, the ordinary onshore bank dollar held up by access to the Federal Reserve, and the old offshore dollar left scrambling to hoard Treasuries to stay credible — and each is engaged in a constant fight to hold its value at exactly one dollar.

VII. The Historical Rhyme

To show that such transitions are not unprecedented, Dines reaches back to the American Civil War. To fund the Union war effort, the government issued "greenbacks" — paper money with nothing behind it, conjured to pay for soldiers and supplies. It was a pure emergency credit money. Yet once victory looked assured, the discussion in capital markets turned to reining it back in, and within roughly a decade the United States had re-anchored its money to gold with the legislation of 1875. The pattern is a cycle: from hard, asset-backed money, into emergency paper credit during the crisis, and back out to asset-backed money once stability returns. It can happen in about a decade. His wager is that we are in the same kind of reset today — and that the asset we re-anchor to this time may not be gold, but Bitcoin.

VIII. Bitcoin as the Global Settlement Layer

Now the two halves of this essay meet. We have a technology — Bitcoin — that is decentralised, scarce to the point of being unprintable, secured by physics, governed by no one, and impossible to debase or seize by decree. And we have a global money system that, by Dines's account, is being rebuilt around assets, real-time settlement, around-the-clock markets, and the tokenisation of everything. As that new world takes shape, it begins to demand something the old one never needed: a neutral, final, incorruptible asset on which everything can ultimately settle — one that no single party controls and no government can quietly inflate. That is the role Dines believes Bitcoin will grow into: the *global settlement layer*.

The argument turns on a distinction between two kinds of money. There is "outside money," controlled by the state and its central bank — money the public can use but never truly hold against the issuer. And there is "inside money," which ordinary people and businesses can hold and settle in directly, acting as a check on both the banks and the state. When your dollar could once be redeemed for a fixed weight of silver or gold, that redeemability was a leash: if the authorities printed too much, people could demand the metal and expose the fraud, so the power to debase was restrained. That leash is the true meaning of "sound money." Bitcoin, in this view, restores it in digital form — a money the private sector can hold that cannot be silently expanded, holding both banks and governments to account.

It also solves a problem at the level of nations. Recall the Byzantine Generals Problem — the challenge of reaching trustworthy agreement among parties who have every reason to distrust one

another. Bitcoin's solution to that problem is not merely technical; it is geopolitical. It allows two adversaries — say, a buyer and seller of oil in two hostile nations — to settle a transaction directly, on a neutral ledger whose rules neither can bend, without routing the payment through some middleman who could be pressured, sanctioned, or corrupted. It is a level playing field that no one owns. In a multipolar world where the old centralised intermediaries are increasingly seen as captured or weaponised, a money that belongs to no one and answers to no one becomes uniquely valuable.

So the layered vision we sketched with Lightning scales up to the whole global economy. On top sit the stablecoins and bank dollars that serve as the everyday unit of account and medium of exchange — fast, familiar, convenient. Beneath them, as the bedrock store of value and the place of final settlement, sits Bitcoin: the firm foundation onto which the upper layers settle, the way gold once underpinned the entire system, but now digital, borderless, weightless, instantly verifiable, and impossible to debase. This does not happen overnight. Dines describes adoption as a long ladder — climbing from hobbyists, to companies holding it on their balance sheets, to investment funds, to ordinary people buying it directly through their brokers, and only eventually to its role as a base-layer reserve. He expects the climb to take not years but decades, perhaps the rest of his life.

IX. Not Guaranteed — and the Stakes

Here we must be as honest as the transcript itself insists on being, because this is the part most easily lost in enthusiasm. None of this is fated. The outcome in which Bitcoin becomes the firm foundation of the world's money is *one possible path among many*, not a prophecy written in the stars. It depends entirely on human choices — on policy, on whether legislatures act, on how the financial system is restructured, and above all on whether the handoff from the old money to the new is managed with wisdom or stumbled through with panic. Dines is emphatic that a national Bitcoin reserve, for instance, is not assured; it would require votes that may not exist, and it could fail. The future, in other words, is genuinely open.

And that is exactly why the stakes are so high — higher, in the end, than markets and portfolios. There are two broad ways a great monetary transition can go. In the constructive version, the changeover is conducted slowly and carefully, over a generation, in a way that preserves people's savings and keeps the social order intact — like swapping out a foundation beam by beam without bringing down the house. In the disorderly version, the old money collapses suddenly, and the savings of millions are wiped out in a rush of hyperinflation. We have seen that second path before. In Weimar Germany, money died in months; the lifetime savings of a whole generation evaporated, the elderly

were reduced to destitution, and into the wreckage of the social order marched the very forces — extremism, demagoguery, violence — that prosperous and stable societies exist to hold at bay. When money breaks, societies can break with it. The choice between building on a firm monetary foundation and building on a fragile one is therefore not a narrow question of finance. It shapes whether the coming transition is orderly or catastrophic — and in that sense, without exaggeration, the trajectory of human civilisation hangs on getting it right. The future of humanity, quite literally, is part of what is at stake.

X. Building on Rock — The Question of Foundations

There is an image, two thousand years old, that captures this more precisely than any modern phrase. At the close of the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus tells of two builders. *"Everyone who hears these words of mine and does them will be like a wise man who built his house on the rock. And the rain fell, and the floods came, and the winds blew and beat on that house, but it did not fall, because it had been founded on the rock. And everyone who hears these words of mine and does not do them will be like a foolish man who built his house on the sand. And the rain fell, and the floods came, and the winds blew and beat against that house, and it fell, and great was the fall of it"* (Matthew 7:24–27).

The teaching is usually read as a lesson about an individual life, and it is. But a house is also a family, a community, a nation, a civilisation — and every one of them is built on *something*. The foundation is whatever the structure ultimately rests upon. And here the metaphor becomes startlingly literal, because a civilisation rests, more than it knows, on its money. Money is the foundation beneath the foundation: the medium through which every contract, every wage, every savings account, every pension, every plan for the future is denominated and stored. Build that foundation on sand — on money that can be printed, inflated, manipulated, and quietly falsified — and the house may stand beautifully in fair weather, but when the storms come, when the crises and wars and inflations beat against it, the rotten foundation gives way, and great is the fall of it. Build it on rock — on money that is honest, scarce, and incorruptible — and the house can weather the storm.

This is not a strained analogy imposed on scripture; the Bible speaks directly, and repeatedly, about the morality of money — and specifically about debasement. The ancient world had no central banks, but it had the same temptation in physical form: the merchant who kept two sets of weights, a heavy one for buying and a light one for selling, cheating his neighbour by falsifying the very measure of value. Against this, the moral law is unambiguous. *"A false balance is an abomination to the Lord, but a just weight is his delight"* (Proverbs 11:1). *"Unequal weights and unequal measures are both alike*

an abomination to the Lord" (Proverbs 20:10). "You shall not have in your bag two kinds of weights, a large and a small. A full and fair weight you shall have" (Deuteronomy 25:13–15). "Shall I acquit the man with dishonest scales, with a bag of deceitful weights?" (Micah 6:11). Across the law, the prophets, and the proverbs, the message is one: the falsification of money is not merely unwise but an *abomination* — a moral evil, because it is theft dressed up as commerce, a lie told through the measuring stick itself.

Read in that light, the modern printing of money is simply the false balance at planetary scale: the silent shaving of value from everyone who holds the currency, the dishonest weight in the bag of the whole economy. And Bitcoin is its precise opposite — a measure that cannot be falsified, a weight that can never be made unequal, a scale honest by mathematical law rather than by the fragile virtue of those in power. It is, in the deepest sense the scriptures intend, a *just weight*. This is why many in this movement, and this essay among them, are willing to call it something stronger than merely "good money." They call it **God's money**: money that embodies honesty, incorruptibility, and truth in weights and measures; money that takes the power to debase out of the hands of men and returns to ordinary people a foundation that cannot be secretly rotted away. To build a society on such money is to build, at last, on rock.

It should be said plainly that this is a statement of conviction and faith, not of empirical proof, and that sincere people — including sincere people of faith — weigh these texts differently; one can hold the economic argument without the theological one, or the reverse. But for anyone who believes that money is, at bottom, a moral matter — that an honest measure is a delight to God and a false one an abomination — the resonance is difficult to dismiss. Sound money as the just weight commanded by the law; a society founded upon it as the house built upon the rock. The choice before this generation, then, is the oldest one in the book: sand, or stone.

XI. Summary

Money exists to solve the deadlock of barter, and it does three jobs at once: it is a *medium of exchange* (the thing everyone accepts), a *unit of account* (the shared measuring stick of value), and a *store of value* (purchasing power moved through time). The hardest of these is the store of value, and the historic enemy of all three is *debasement* — the issuer quietly printing more and robbing every holder.

Bitcoin is a new kind of money built to make debasement impossible. It is decentralised, with no CEO, no headquarters, and no company at its centre; it is open source; it is independent of governments and banks; and it is secured by cryptography, where a secret private key proves ownership without ever being revealed. Its ledger, the *blockchain*, is protected by *proof of work*: miners burn real energy to add each block, and the chain with the most accumulated work is the truth, while a network of independent nodes enforces the rules — so thousands of strangers reach agreement with no one in charge.

Its supply is fixed forever at just under **21 million coins**, released on a halving schedule that no one can alter, while the *difficulty adjustment* recalibrates every two weeks to hold the *ten-minute* block heartbeat steady no matter how much mining power exists. Everyday payments scale up a second layer, the *Lightning Network*, where instant, near-free transactions settle down onto the secure base chain — a layered design that lets the whole system grow without sacrificing its foundation.

Against this backdrop, **Matt Dines argues that the dollar itself is being rebuilt** — from a London-centred, liability-based "offshore" dollar toward a Washington-centred, asset-backed "stablecoin" dollar reserved one-for-one with Treasury bills — and that, as in the greenback-to-gold cycle of the 1800s, the system is moving back toward hard money. In the 24/7, tokenised world this creates, **Bitcoin is positioned to become the global settlement layer**: the neutral, final, incorruptible bedrock — "inside money" that checks both banks and states and lets even adversaries transact on a level playing field no one controls.

But **this outcome is not guaranteed**. It depends on human choices, it will take decades, and it could fail. The alternative — a disorderly monetary collapse — has wrecked societies before and could again, which is why the stakes reach beyond finance to the stability of civilisation itself.

The essay closes on the oldest image of all: the wise builder founds his house on **rock**, the foolish on **sand**. A civilisation rests on its money, and the scriptures call the falsification of money — the false balance, the unequal weight — an abomination, while an honest weight is a delight. By that measure, sound and incorruptible money is the just weight, and a society built upon it is the house upon the rock. It is in this sense that the essay calls Bitcoin **God's money** — held here as a conviction of faith, offered for the reader to weigh — and frames the choice before us as the one between building on sand and building on stone.



Sources & references. Primary: "The Dollar Changed. Bitcoin Is the Endgame" — *What Bitcoin Did* podcast with Danny Knowles and Matt Dines (Build Asset Management; host of *MindPrint*; X: @LeveredUSTs). Technical foundations: Satoshi Nakamoto, *Bitcoin: A Peer-to-Peer Electronic Cash System* (2008) and the Bitcoin genesis block (2009). Monetary history referenced in the episode: Edwin Vieira Jr., *Pieces of Eight*; Adam Fergusson, *When Money Dies*; the U.S. Civil-War greenbacks and the Resumption/Remonetisation Act of 1875; the GENIUS Act (2025); the LIBOR-to-SOFR transition. Scripture quoted from the English Standard Version: Matthew 7:24–27; Proverbs 11:1; Proverbs 20:10; Deuteronomy 25:13–15; Micah 6:11. The economic interpretations are Matt Dines's framework as expressed in the cited interview; the Bitcoin fundamentals are technical facts of the protocol; the closing reflection on foundations and "God's money" is offered as a conviction of faith, which readers will weigh for themselves.